

MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

A Reconciling Congregation
WE SEEK, WE SERVE, WE CELEBRATE

December 24, 2020

Welcome Friends!

We welcome you to worship wherever you may be in your faith's journey. We strive to live in the way of Jesus Christ, sharing God's love on a daily basis regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history.

If you are new to our church community,
please fill out some information about yourself in the "visitor" tab of our website.
You can learn a little bit more about us, and get yourself added to our email information lists.

Gathering Music

Tim Siefkes, keyboards

Dreams of Butterflies (On a Christmas Night)

Antonio Vivaldi "Winter" concerto, arr. Trans-Siberian Orchestra
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Welcome

Lighting of the Advent Wreath

Candle Lighters: The Cook Family



Congregational Hymn

Led by Alex Rack and Anders Nelson

O Come, All Ye Faithful

John F. Wade, c. 1743

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O come, all ye faithful, joyful and triumphant,
O come ye, O come ye, to Bethlehem.
Come and behold him, born the King of angels;

Refrain:

O come, let us adore him, O come, let us adore him,
O come, let us adore him, Christ the Lord.

True God of true God, Light from Light Eternal,
lo, he shuns not the Virgin's womb;
Son of the Creator, begotten, not created;
(Refrain)

Sing, choirs of angels, sing in exultation;
O sing, all ye citizens of heaven above!
Glory to God, all glory in the highest;
(Refrain)

See how the shepherds, summoned to his cradle,
leaving their flocks, draw nigh to gaze;
we too will thither bend our joyful footsteps;
(Refrain)

Christmas Prayer

(adapted from Feasting on the Word, ed. Kimberly Bracken Long)

Living God, on this holy night we gather – to stand with the shepherds, amazed at your glory; to sing with angels, rejoicing in your work; to wait with Joseph, trusting in your promise; to sit with Mary, cradling your love. May the good news of this night inspire us to tell the world of our great joy: for you are born in our midst tonight and in each new day.
Amen.

Special Music

Anders Nelson, *organ*

Lo How a Rose E'er Blooming

arr. John Leavitt

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Reading

Annette Meier

Isaiah 9:2-3, 6-7

Children's Message

Jenia Strom

Special Music

It Came Upon a Midnight Clear

arr. David Cherwien

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Reading

Jenny Ammerman

Luke 2:1-7

Story of Courage

Mary McLeod Bethune

Special Music

Josh Espinosa

In the Bleak Midwinter

1906 Gustav Holst arr. Josh Espinosa

Reading

The Regan Family

Luke 2:8-20

Story of Courage

Bayard Rustin

Special Music

Anders Nelson, Alex Rack, Josh Espinosa, Tim Siefkes

White Christmas

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Reading

Annie Strom

Psalm 98

Story of Courage

Standing Rock

Special Music

Anders Nelson, Alex Rack, Josh Espinosa, Tim Siefkes

It's Beginning to Look a Lot Like Christmas

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Offertory

Vocals: Jenn Schroeder & Jason Vosu, vocals;

Tim Siefkes, keyboards and percussion; Pat Lyall, cello

Mike Forrest, electric guitar; Josh Espinosa, bass

Little Drummer Boy (Bolero)

Harry Simeone, Katherine Kennicott Davis and Henry Onorati, arr. Tim Siefkes

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Prayer of Dedication

Empower our offerings to be used to share the good news we have seen and heard. Equip us to sing with angels and run with shepherds. Fill us with your peace, that we may live more fully as peacemakers. Expand the horizons of our understanding and expectation, that we may move with confidence into those wider arenas where you call us to serve. Amen

Congregational Hymn

Led by Alex Rack and Anders Nelson

Silent Night

Franz Gruber, c. 1818

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Silent night, holy night,
all is calm, all is bright
round yon virgin mother and child.
Holy infant, so tender and mild,
sleep in heavenly peace,
sleep in heavenly peace.

Silent night, holy night,
shepherds quake at the sight;
glories stream from heaven afar,
heavenly hosts sing Alleluia!
Christ the Savior is born,
Christ the Savior is born!

Silent night, holy night,
Son of God, love's pure light;
radiant beams from thy holy face
with the dawn of redeeming grace,
Jesus, Lord, at thy birth,
Jesus, Lord, at thy birth.

Silent night, holy night,
wondrous star, lend thy light;
with the angels let us sing,
Alleluia to our King;
Christ the Savior is born,
Christ the Savior is born!

Benediction

Worship Personnel

Rev. Becky Sechrist, *Pastor*;

Jenia Strom, *Program Director of Children, Youth, and Families*

Alex Rack, *Choir Director*; Anders Nelson, *Organist*; Tim Siefkes and Josh Espinosa, *Contemporary Band Leaders*;

Nicholas Sabah, *Communion Steward*

Thank you to: Dean Ammerman & Pete Ketcham for video production and Anders Nelson & Tim Siefkes for music production

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